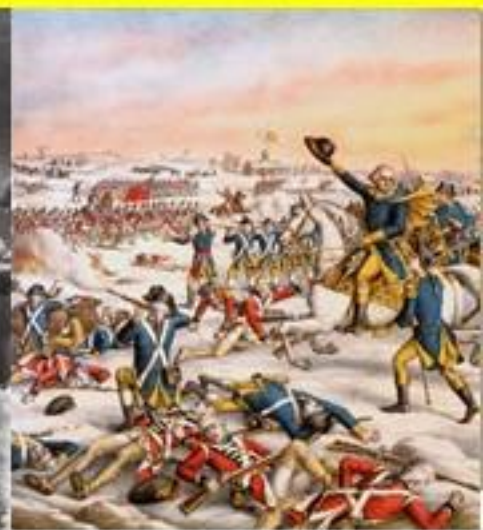


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 10

**AMERICAN
REVOLUTION - 2**

AMERICA VS BRITAIN

FIRST BATTLE

- The war started in 1775, when the first battle was fought between the British soldiers and the colonial militia at Lexington in Massachusetts.
- Soon, George Washington assume the command of the army of the American colonies.
- The British General, Gage won a victory at Bunker Hill.



BATTLE OF LONG ISLAND

- In 1776 the British forces led by Sir William Howe defeated Washington in the battle of Long Island.



AMERICA VS BRITAIN

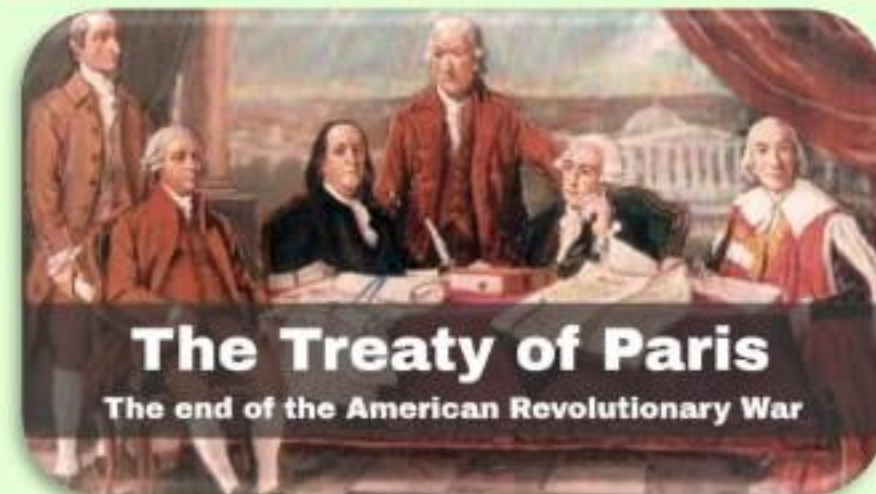
BATTLE AT SARATOGA

- The army of American colonies commanded by General Gates defeated British troops at Saratoga in October, 1777.
- The victory at Saratoga marked a turning point in the war.
- The French troops under Lafayette came to the help of the American colonies.



TREATY OF PARIS

- Finally, the British troops under the command of General Cornwallis surrendered to Washington at Yorktown in 1781.
- The war came to an end by the Treaty of Paris in 1783.



WHAT KIND OF CONCLUSIONS CAN WE DRAW FROM THE AMERICAN WAR OF INDEPENDENCE?

BILL OF RIGHTS

- The American colonies became free and the Republic of the United States of America was established.
- The first democratic government with a written constitution in the world became a reality.
- The Bill of Rights ensured fundamental rights to the citizens of the U.S.A.

INSPIRATION TO FRENCH REVOLUTION

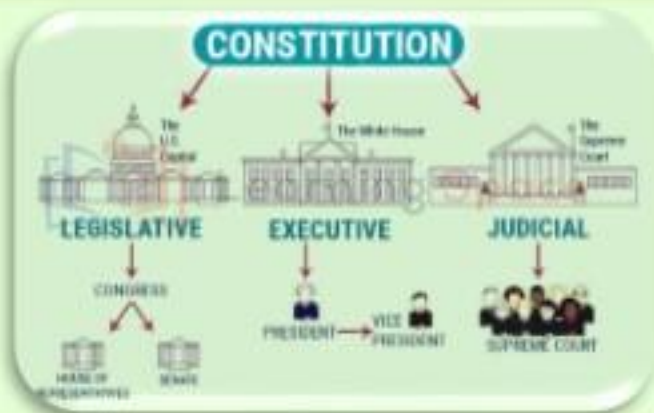
- The American War of Independence was also called the American Revolution because it inspired the French Revolution.
- It was not only a war against England but against aristocracy and reactionary elements. It was also a fight against colonial domination.



WHAT KIND OF CONCLUSIONS CAN WE DRAW FROM THE AMERICAN WAR OF INDEPENDENCE?

DEMOCRATIC PRINCIPLES

- It introduced new political, social and economic set up in the United States of America.
- Democracy with separation of powers on the model suggested by French thinker Montesquieu was founded.
- Capitalism also took strong roots.



NEGLECT OF RIGHTS TO ABORIGINALS

- However, the rights of the sons of the soil, the Red Indians and the Negroes were not considered at that time.



WHAT KIND OF CONCLUSIONS CAN WE DRAW FROM THE AMERICAN WAR OF INDEPENDENCE?

ECONOMIC ASPECTS

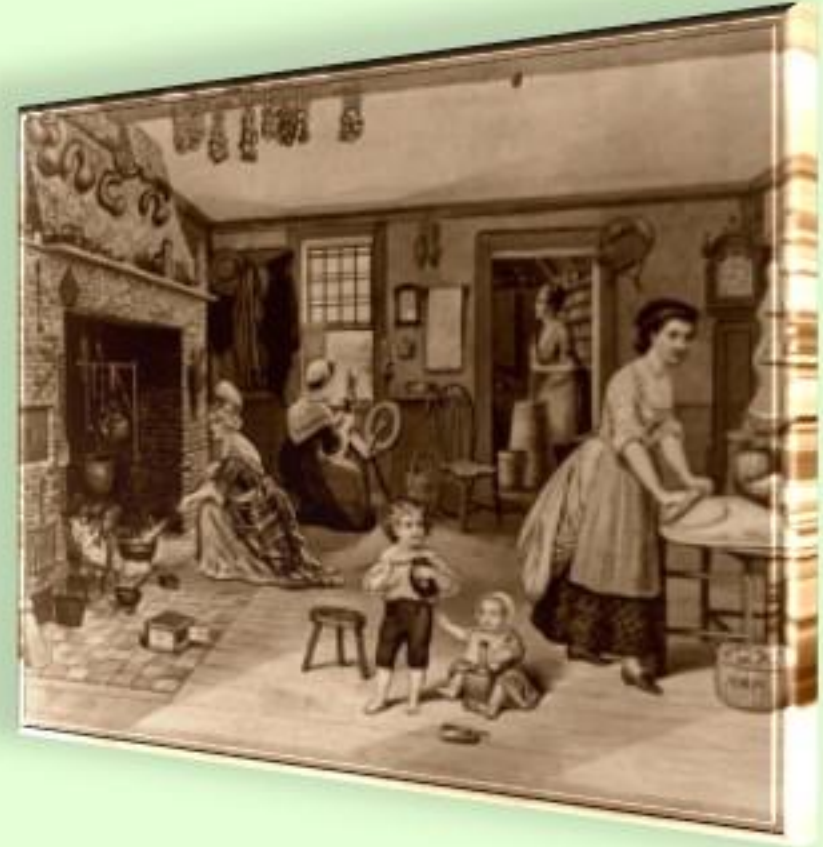
- American Revolution gave the impetus to the policy of liberalism and free trade.
- It was realized that the principles of free trade and commercial monopoly were opposed to each other..
- The erstwhile conservative policy of denial of economic independence was considerably relaxed.
- The policy of economic interference was relaxed.



WHAT KIND OF CONCLUSIONS CAN WE DRAW FROM THE AMERICAN WAR OF INDEPENDENCE?

SOCIAL ASPECTS

- American Revolution not only ended feudal forms of land tenure but supported more enlightened attitude towards the family.
- After the Revolution the patriarchal control of men over their wives declined, the latter gaining the right to hold property separately and to make contracts and do business in the absence of their husbands.
- The equal rights of widows and daughters were recognized in matters concerning inheritance and possession of property.
- Women now gained the power to be able to divorce their husbands if they chose to.
- However, this power was only available in some colonies.





SEQUENCE OF EVENTS

Mid eighteenth century	English -thirteen colonies -Atlantic coast
Relationship between British and colony	Initially cordial
Colonies	Controlled through the governors,
Policies- home government (Britain)	Led to the American War of Independence
Mercantilism	Colonies -benefit of the mother country
Navigation Act	All the goods of both exports and imports should be carried in ships owned by England.
The Molasses Act	Heavy duties on sugar and molasses imported into the American colonies
The end of Seven Years War	American colonies decided to face the colonial attitude of the British.
Granville Measures	Series of Acts -affecting the interests of the American colonies- severely opposed by the colonists. They raised the slogan "No Taxation without Representation"
Townshend laws	Fresh taxes on glass, paper, tea, paints, etc

Boston Tea Party	A group of Americans dressed as Red Indians, climbed on the ships and threw away the tea bundles into the sea at the Boston harbour.
Philadelphia Congress	The American colonists decided to unite in their fight against the British.
Declaration of Independence	It laid emphasis on the unalienable rights of men namely, "Life, Liberty and Pursuit of happiness".
The Bill of Rights	Fundamental rights to the citizens of the U.S.A
Democracy	Separation of powers -French thinker Montesquieu was founded.
Sons of the soil	Red Indians and the Negroes were not considered at that time.
Inspiration to French Revolution	It was a war on aristocracy and reactionary elements.
Economic Independence	Policy of liberalism and free trade.
Position of Women	Equal rights of widows and daughters- inheritance and possession of property.

QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. Analyse the reasons for escalating anti-British sentiment in the American colonies. 250 words
2. What did American colonies mean by "No taxation without representation"? 150 words
3. The American Revolution was essentially as economic conflict between American capitalism as British mercantilism. 250 words
4. What are the factors that led to the growth of American Nationalism. 150 words



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